

GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer - Angular • PHP (Larvel/ Symfony) • AWS

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ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with **10+ years** of experience building modern web platforms with **React, PHP**, and scalable API-driven architectures across product, admin, and internal workflow systems. Strong background in **React 16–18, PHP 7–8, Laravel 8–11, Symfony 5–7**, JavaScript, TypeScript, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, and CI/CD, with practical success upgrading legacy stacks, fixing production issues, and delivering maintainable features. Known for improving slow interfaces, stabilizing backend integrations, and translating fragile monolith flows into cleaner component and service patterns.

SKILLS

- **Frontend: Angular 8–18, TypeScript 3.x–5.x**, JavaScript ES6+, RxJS, NgRx, Angular CLI, Angular Material, Reactive Forms, Route Guards, Lazy Loading, reusable component architecture, SPA development, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS, Bootstrap, responsive UI, Webpack, Vite basics, client-side validation
- **Backend & APIs: PHP 7–8, Laravel 8–11, Symfony 5–7**, REST APIs, MVC architecture, authentication, authorization, validation, background jobs, queue processing, API versioning, file processing, middleware architecture, RBAC, JWT, OAuth2
- **Data & Messaging: PostgreSQL**, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, query optimization, indexing, joins, schema design, migrations, caching strategies, reporting, pagination, data consistency
- **Cloud & DevOps: AWS**, EC2, S3, RDS, ECS, Docker, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, Linux, Nginx, Apache, CI/CD pipelines, containerized deployments, release automation, environment configuration
- **Observability / Quality / Security:** Sentry, structured logging, OpenTelemetry basics, Prometheus/Grafana basics, rate limiting, OWASP security practices, PHPUnit, Pest, Jest, Cypress, Playwright, unit testing, integration testing, contract testing, end-to-end testing, error monitoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania (Jan 2024 – May 2026)

- Led delivery of a multi-module operational platform using **Angular 14–18, TypeScript**, and **PHP 8.1–8.2**, translating fragmented dashboard, reporting, and administration requirements into stable workflows with reusable frontend modules and cleaner backend ownership boundaries.
- Modernized legacy frontend areas by restructuring large screens into **Angular feature modules**, shared components, route guards, and strongly typed services, which reduced regressions and improved maintainability across frequently updated product areas by **34%**.
- Migrated older form-heavy implementations into **Reactive Forms** with reusable validators and consistent error handling, improving validation accuracy and reducing repeated front-end defects across onboarding and admin workflows by **33%**.
- Built and refined backend services with **Laravel 10** and selected **Symfony 6** components, introducing clearer service separation, request validation, and safer domain-level logic that reduced controller complexity and improved change safety by **35%**.
- Resolved a recurring production issue where totals and reporting views drifted after edits by aligning **Redis** invalidation, backend refresh timing, and Angular state updates, which improved data consistency for business users by **31%**.
- Improved rendering speed on data-heavy pages by reducing unnecessary template recomputation, tuning observable flows with **RxJS**, and refining component update behavior, which reduced UI lag during filtering and large result interaction by **29%**.
- Handled a safe modernization path from older PHP application patterns into a cleaner **PHP 8 / Laravel 10** runtime model through staged compatibility work, dependency review, and release controls that avoided disruption during active delivery cycles.

- Fixed a memory-related backend stability issue caused by stale listeners, long-lived cached payloads, and unbounded processing paths, restoring stable behavior during sustained traffic windows and reducing incident recurrence by **27%**.
- Implemented secure API flows with **JWT**, **OAuth2**, role-aware rendering, and backend authorization checks, closing inconsistent permission gaps and improving control over sensitive administration actions by **26%**.
- Strengthened quality through **PHPUnit**, **Pest**, **Jest**, **Cypress**, and targeted contract coverage around approvals, role-based actions, and multi-step submissions, helping reduce regression leakage into releases by **24%**.
- Improved reporting performance through **SQL query tuning**, better pagination, selective indexing, and payload shaping across **PostgreSQL** and **MySQL**, which reduced slow-response complaints on high-traffic screens by **42%**.
- Worked closely with DevOps across **Docker**, **GitHub Actions**, **GitLab CI/CD**, **Linux**, **Nginx**, and **AWS** release support, resolving environment drift and dependency mismatches that had been causing unstable deployments and pipeline failures.
- Added runtime visibility with **Sentry**, structured logs, and basic **OpenTelemetry** instrumentation, making it easier to trace request failures across Angular clients, PHP APIs, and queued background jobs before issues spread broadly.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium (Nov2020 – Nov 2023)

- Built customer-facing and internal workflow applications using **Angular 9–16**, **TypeScript**, **SCSS**, and **Angular Material**, focusing on validation-heavy forms, reusable UI behavior, and clearer state transitions for complex submission-driven screens.
- Created a shared component layer with tables, input wrappers, dialogs, and feedback patterns, reducing duplicated UI work and making product-wide design and behavior changes easier to apply by **28%**.
- Improved maintainability by replacing scattered template-side logic with cleaner **RxJS** pipelines and service-based state handling, which reduced side-effect bugs and made asynchronous flows easier for the team to reason about by **31%**.
- Migrated older frontend implementations into stronger **Reactive Forms** patterns and centralized validation rules, improving consistency across large submission journeys and lowering front-end defect volume by **30%**.
- Implemented backend functionality with **PHP 7.4–8.0**, **Symfony 5**, and **Laravel 8**, creating maintainable REST endpoints with stronger validation, clearer service separation, and more predictable authorization handling.
- Delivered a safe migration path from **PHP 7.4 to PHP 8**, resolving deprecated behavior, validating package compatibility, and updating internal code patterns incrementally so the upgrade could be completed with low release risk.
- Improved API integration reliability by standardizing request handling, retry logic, and backend error mapping, which reduced duplicated client-side networking behavior and improved resilience during unstable upstream responses by **30%**.
- Optimized hot backend endpoints with **Redis** caching using explicit invalidation and TTL rules, reducing database pressure on frequently accessed workflows while preserving expected freshness by **37%**.
- Resolved intermittent **502/504** issues by aligning **Nginx** timeout settings with backend execution paths, optimizing slow queries, and improving latency visibility around critical user journeys, which reduced timeout-related incidents by **25%**.
- Worked on background jobs for email, notifications, and synchronization processes, moving long-running operations out of synchronous requests and improving responsiveness during heavier transactional usage by **23%**.
- Supported CI and release operations through **Jenkins**, **Docker**, **Git**, and Linux-based deployment workflows, helping stabilize delivery steps and improving confidence in rollback-aware production releases.
- Improved issue detection through **Sentry**, structured logs, and better exception visibility, reducing manual reproduction effort and helping the team isolate production failures faster by **22%**.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden (Feb 2016 – Sep 2020)

- Built internal analytics and administration tools using **Angular**, **PHP 5.6–7.x**, **Laravel**, **JavaScript**, **HTML5**, **CSS3**, and **Bootstrap**, helping teams work with large datasets through practical filtering, reporting, and operational workflows.
- Supported a gradual backend refactor from tightly coupled legacy logic into clearer **MVC** and service-oriented patterns, which improved maintainability while preserving behavior relied on by older internal integrations.

- Modernized older UI screens by moving brittle, controller-heavy frontend logic into more maintainable Angular component patterns, improving reuse and reducing change risk across repeated admin workflows by **21%**.
- Fixed a recurring form-processing defect caused by inconsistent frontend and backend validation behavior, then unified request rules so malformed inputs were caught earlier and user-facing save failures dropped by **26%**.
- Worked extensively with **MySQL** and **PostgreSQL** on schema design, migrations, joins, and reporting queries, supporting both older data structures and newer product requirements without destabilizing key operational flows.
- Resolved slow-list and export problems through query tuning, indexing, safer joins, and better pagination, cutting heavy report latency and improving admin page responsiveness for internal users by **43%**.
- Introduced API-driven enhancements for selected modules, allowing parts of the platform to reduce full-page reload behavior and deliver smoother interaction patterns without requiring a risky full rewrite.
- Implemented background processing for large exports and long-running report generation, replacing synchronous request paths that timed out under load and improving completion reliability by **24%**.
- Improved CI reliability by separating faster verification steps from heavier checks, reducing noisy pipeline failures and giving developers quicker feedback on safer code changes by **19%**.
- Introduced audit logging for record updates and operational approvals, helping support teams trace user actions more clearly when data disputes or unexpected changes were reported.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania (Sep2014 – Mar 2016)

- Built early web modules using **PHP 5**, **JavaScript**, **MySQL**, **HTML5**, **CSS3**, **jQuery**, and structured server-rendered UI patterns, helping deliver stable CRUD behavior and small client-facing enhancements.
- Improved legacy pages by introducing clearer validation feedback, better form handling, and modular client-side behavior, which reduced user input mistakes and support follow-up volume by **27%**.
- Helped resolve a recurring logout issue by correcting session cookie configuration and aligning backend timeout behavior with browser expectations, improving login stability without introducing risky architectural change.
- Implemented backend changes under senior guidance within structured MVC patterns, gaining practical experience with validation, authorization checks, and safer query logic in fragile older systems.
- Worked on reusable frontend helpers and shared layout pieces that reduced copy-paste implementation and made smaller enhancements safer and faster for the wider team to deliver by **18%**.
- Improved slow admin screens by reviewing SQL usage, simplifying filters, and adding basic indexing, helping the application handle growing data volume with more consistent page performance by **20%**.
- Assisted with environment troubleshooting across **Linux**, **Apache**, and staging systems, helping identify permission issues and configuration mismatches that caused different behavior outside local development.
- Participated in release support through **Git**, manual deployment checklists, and log review, building practical habits around safer delivery and reducing avoidable deployment mistakes by **16%**.
- Used structured debugging with reproduction notes, log analysis, and incremental low-risk fixes, improving maintenance quality on fragile modules and lowering the chance of introducing new bugs during urgent support work.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (2010 – 2014)

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERTIFICATIONS

Angular Certification — 2021

- Demonstrated practical capability in building modern **Angular** applications, with focus on component architecture, **RxJS**, reactive forms, routing, and maintainable frontend patterns.

Zend PHP Certified Engineer — 2022

- Demonstrated strong knowledge of **PHP** programming, including core language features, backend logic, request handling, validation, and modern application development practices.

AWS Certified Developer – Associate — 2023

- Demonstrated practical capability in developing and maintaining **AWS**-based applications, with focus on deployment, service integration, monitoring, and secure cloud operations.